Fact: DESERT

A Desert is a large area that gets very low rainfall and very few plants and animals. There are two types of deserts found in Asia, Hot and cold deserts.

DO YOU KNOW?

Rub-Al Khali desert is the largest, continuous sandy desert in the world. It is found in the southeastern part of Saudi Arabia.

Resource Base and Economic Activities of Asia

Mineral Resources

Asia has a variety of mineral deposits. It holds an important place in the production of **Iron, Coal, Manganese, Bauxite, Zinc, Tungsten, Petroleum, Tin** etc. **Oil** and **Natural Gas** found in the west Asian countries. One third of the world's oil is produced in Asia. Among the west Asian countries, **Iran** has a considerable wealth of mineral resources. The important minerals found in Asia are:

Iron Ore: Asia has the largest deposits of iron ore in the world. **China** and **India** are the important iron ore deposit countries of Asia. **Turkey, Philippines, Malaysia, Thailand, Myanmar** etc., are a few other countries that have iron ore deposits.

Coal: Coal is a **fossil fuel.** Asia has the largest deposits of coal in the world. **China** and **India** are the largest producers of coal in Asia.

Petroleum: Petroleum is a **mineral oi**l. The largest petroleum reserves are found in South West Asia. The important petroleum producing countries are **Saudi Arabia**, **Kuwait, Iran, Bahrain, Qatar** and **UAE. South China, Malaysia, Brunei, Indonesia, India, Russia** are the other important petroleum producing countries in Asia.



Coal mine in India

Bauxite is found in India and **Indonesia**. **India** is the largest producer of **Mica** in the world. **Tin** is found in **Myanmar, Thailand, Malaysia** and **Indonesia**.

Agriculture

Only about 18 percent of the total area is cultivable in Asia. Agriculture is the chief occupation of the people here. The river valleys in the South, South East and East Asia have rich alluvial soil. Agriculture is intensively practised in the riverine plains of Asia. However, some areas are not suitable for agricultural practices. **India** has the largest area of **arable lands** in Asia. Most of the west Asian countries cultivate their crops where the ground water level is nearer to the surface. Iraq practices agricultural activities based on the availability of rainfall and supply of water from Euphrates and Tigris rivers.

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